

Media Studies and Journalism Department

Portfolio Report

Submitted By

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Term: Summer 2026
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MSJ041

Plagiarism Declaration

- I know that plagiarism means taking and using the ideas, writings, works or inventions of another as if they were one's own. I know that plagiarism not only includes verbatim copying but also the extensive use of another person's ideas without proper acknowledgement (which includes the proper use of quotation marks). I know that plagiarism covers this sort of use of material found in textual sources and from the Internet.
- I acknowledge and understand that plagiarism is wrong.

- I understand that my research must be accurately referenced.
- This assignment is my own work, or my group's own unique group assignment. I acknowledge that copying someone else's assignment, or part of it, is wrong and that submitting identical work to others constitutes a form of plagiarism.
- I have not allowed, nor will I in the future allow, anyone to copy my work with the intention of passing it off as their own work.

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Signature _____
 Student Details

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Department	:	Media Studies and Journalism
Major Concentration	:	Communication for Development
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PPORTFOLIO APPROVAL FORM

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----- Advisor APPROVAL (Please place a Tick)
☐ Approved ☐ Not Approved ☐ Partial Re-write ☐ Full Re-write

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Introduction

I am Faria Akter, a student in the Department of Media Studies and Journalism at the University of Liberal Arts Bangladesh (ULAB), with a major concentration in Communication for Development and a minor in English. This portfolio brings together fourteen projects completed across my undergraduate coursework, tracing my development as a communicator working across journalism, development communication, health communication, participatory research, and creative media. The collection spans original feature reporting and interview-based journalism, communication strategy and campaign design for public health and development challenges, participatory fieldwork with an Indigenous community, critical institutional analysis, and creative work produced for Curriculum Integration exhibitions. Together, these projects reflect both a grounding in communication theory and a consistent practical interest in using communication to serve underserved communities, hold institutions accountable, and translate complex social issues into messages that reach real audiences.

Self-Reflection

Objectives

Through this portfolio, I aim to demonstrate the range of communication skills I have developed over the course of my degree: the ability to conduct original field and interview-based reporting; to design theory-grounded communication and health communication strategies for real development challenges in Bangladesh; to carry out ethical, community-centred participatory research; and to translate complex academic concepts into creative, audience-facing formats, from visual art to broadcast and advertising scripts. I also aim to show a consistent thread of critical, accountability-driven thinking running through my academic and professional work, and to reflect on how these combined skills have prepared me for my long-term goal of building an independent, communication-driven enterprise.

PROJECTS

Project 1: Research Proposal

Course Code and Title: MSJ 1201 Communication Research

Project Title: Branding Sculpture among Bangladeshi People

Project Date: Spring 2023**Project Description**

A group research proposal investigating public perception of sculpture as a viable art form and career path in Bangladesh, developed for the Communication Research course. The proposal opens by identifying the core problem: sculpture remains culturally undervalued and overlooked next to conventional "respectable" professions like medicine or engineering, despite genuine artistic and economic potential behind it. Built around five clearly defined research objectives — ranging from understanding public attitudes toward sculpture, to identifying strategies that could attract more people into the field, to exploring its potential to generate foreign income for Bangladesh — the proposal lays out a full qualitative research design. This includes a structured literature review establishing the existing gap in research on this topic, a data-collection strategy combining a single focus group discussion with systematic random sampling of one in every ten residents in the Bandarban area, and a complete project timeframe and budget for carrying out the fieldwork.

Project Justification

This project demonstrates the ability to design a complete, methodologically sound qualitative research proposal as part of a team, starting from an observed social gap and working through to a fully specified, executable research plan. It required defining a clear, narrow set of research objectives rather than an open-ended question, conducting a literature review to justify why the research was needed, and choosing sampling and data-collection methods appropriate to a niche, under-studied topic. It also required practical planning skills — setting a feasible timeframe and realistic budget for actual fieldwork — that go beyond theoretical coursework into applied research management. This early academic research training directly underlies the more advanced, rigorous qualitative research design Faria now applies in her master's thesis.

[Insert your PROJECT on the next page]**Learning and Outcomes**

Learned to build a full qualitative research proposal from the ground up: framing a research problem, conducting a structured literature review, and designing an appropriate sampling and data-collection strategy (focus group discussion, systematic random sampling). Developed early skills in group research planning, budgeting for fieldwork, and setting a realistic project timeframe — foundational to the more advanced qualitative research design used in the master's thesis.

Project 2: Mask Making

Course Code and Title: Curriculum Integration (CI) — Theme: Rational Choice Theory**Project Title:** From Chains to Change — Group Mask Installation**Project Date:****Project Description**

A co-authored mixed-media mask installation exploring Rational Choice Theory through the lens of oppression, fear, and resistance. The mask is divided into a darker half representing restriction and a brighter half representing hope, surrounded by chains and barbed wire symbolising the forces that limit human choice, with a raised fist at the centre representing the decision to resist. The report documents the concept development, the symbolic use of colour and materials, the production and installation process, the exhibition, and structured audience feedback on whether the intended message was understood.

Project Justification

This project demonstrates the ability to collaboratively translate an abstract academic theory into a symbolic visual language legible to a general audience, and to gather and interpret structured audience feedback on that translation. It shows early competence in framing complex ideas through concrete, emotionally resonant imagery — a skill directly transferable to narrative framing in journalism.

[Insert your PROJECT on the next page]

Learning and Outcomes

Learned to collaboratively translate abstract social theory into a physical, symbol-driven visual narrative; developed skills in concept pitching, shared creative decision-making, and using colour/material choices deliberately to carry meaning. Gained practical experience in collecting and interpreting structured audience feedback to test whether an intended message actually reaches viewers, and in critically reflecting on gaps between creative intent and audience interpretation.

Project 3: Blog Writing (Comm. Tech)

Course Code and Title: Communication Technology

Project Title: The Dual Lives of Bangladeshi Young Footballers

Project Date:

Project Description

A short comparative feature profiling two young footballers on divergent paths after representing Bangladesh: Apu Roy, a 2018 Bangabandhu Gold Cup champion who left football to become a barber due to financial hardship, and Shaon, who continued in the sport with the backing of a footballing family. Built on direct interviews, the piece interrogates structural inequality and the lack of institutional support for talent in Bangladeshi football.

Project Justification

Demonstrates the ability to conduct original interview-based reporting and produce a publication-ready feature using digital writing and communication technology tools, building a comparative human-interest narrative that surfaces a structural critique of inequality in Bangladeshi sport through individual stories — early evidence of the narrative feature-writing approach later developed at TBS Panorama.

[Insert your PROJECT on the next page]

Learning and Outcomes

Learned to conduct and structure interview-based reporting, to build a narrative around contrast between two real subjects rather than a single profile, and to let individual stories carry a broader structural argument about inequality and opportunity. Strengthened skills in producing publication-ready feature content using digital writing and communication technology tools.

Project 4: Advance English Writing

Course Code and Title:

Project Title:

Project Date:

Project Description

[Pending — to be completed once this project file is provided.]

Project Justification

[Pending — to be completed once this project file is provided.]

[Insert your PROJECT on the next page]

Learning and Outcomes

[Pending — to be completed once this project file is provided.]

Project 5: Advance Bangla Writing

Course Code and Title:

Project Title:

Project Date:

Project Description

[Pending — to be completed once this project file is provided.]

Project Justification

[Pending — to be completed once this project file is provided.]

[Insert your PROJECT on the next page]

Learning and Outcomes

[Pending — to be completed once this project file is provided.]

Project 6: Trashion Show

Course Code and Title: Curriculum Integration (CI) — Theme: Eco-System Restoration

Project Title: Individual Report — Upcycled “Jungle” Trashion Garment

Project Date: December 2023

Project Description

An individual report documenting the design, production, and exhibition of an upcycled “trashion” garment built from reused green cloth, a repurposed wing, and broken shoes, representing a jungle destroyed by human action. The report covers the concept and layout rationale, the full production process (materials, team dynamics, obstacles), the exhibition setting, and structured feedback collected from five interviewees on message clarity and creative execution.

Project Justification

The project shows early competency in translating an environmental theme into a public-facing creative artifact, structuring audience feedback collection, and critically reflecting on both creative process and reception — foundational skills for narrative-driven, audience-centered communication work later expanded in professional feature writing.

[Insert your PROJECT on the next page]

Learning and Outcomes

Learned to design and construct a wearable creative artifact from a theoretical/environmental prompt, manage a small production team under time pressure, and improvise with limited resources (upcycled materials). Developed skills in running structured audience-feedback interviews and using that feedback to critically evaluate whether a creative work communicated its intended message.

Project 7: Video Art

Course Code and Title: Curriculum Integration (CI) — Theme: Rational Choice Theory

Project Title: Table of Strain

Project Date:

Project Description

An individual reflection on a video-art piece visualising the emotional and psychological tension underlying decision-making. Using a confined circular frame, repetitive hand movements over fragmented objects, and lighting that shifts from dark to intense red, the work reinterprets Rational Choice Theory as a felt experience of pressure rather than a purely rational calculation.

Project Justification

Shows full individual authorship — concept, production, and critical reflection — and the capacity to render an academic theoretical framework in a non-literal, emotionally resonant register, reflecting the kind of interpretive, theory-grounded thinking now applied in thesis research.

[Insert your PROJECT on the next page]

Learning and Outcomes

Learned to independently plan and execute a short video-art piece, making deliberate choices around framing, lighting, and repetition to build emotional meaning without dialogue or explanation. Gained experience managing every stage of production solo — concept, filming, and editing — and reflecting critically on how abstract theory can be represented through sustained visual metaphor.

Project 8: Project Plan

Course Code and Title: C4D Communication Planning and Process

Project Title: Reducing Childhood Malnutrition in Rural Bangladesh — Communication Strategy

Project Date:

Project Description

A full communication-for-development strategy addressing childhood malnutrition in rural Bangladesh, built on a problem-tree analysis (poverty, maternal education, sanitation, healthcare access, cultural beliefs) and structured using the Logical Framework (Log Frame) approach. The plan defines goals, objectives, target behaviours (exclusive breastfeeding, hygiene, dietary diversity), multi-channel communication activities (health worker visits, radio, SMS, mother support groups), and monitoring indicators.

Project Justification

Demonstrates the ability to design a full evidence-based, multi-stakeholder development communication strategy from root-cause diagnosis to measurable behaviour-change outcomes — reflecting strong grounding in C4D frameworks (Log Frame Analysis, BCC) that inform Faria's broader interest in health communication and stigma-reduction strategy, directly relevant to her master's research on health information-seeking behaviour.

[Insert your PROJECT on the next page]

Learning and Outcomes

Learned to build a communication strategy from root-cause analysis (problem tree) through to a full Log Frame structure with measurable indicators, verification methods, and risk assumptions. Developed skills in aligning multiple communication channels (interpersonal, mass media, digital) around a single behaviour-change goal, and in setting realistic, quantifiable success targets for a development intervention.

Project 9: Research Project

Course Code and Title: Participatory Research (PR-1)

Project Title: Water Crisis and Health Problems in a Marma Community of Bandarban

Project Date: Spring 2026

Project Description

A field-based participatory research study conducted with the Marma Indigenous community of Amtoli Marma Para, Bandarban, examining how residents cope with seasonal water shortages and waterborne illness. Using Farmers Field School sessions, transect walks, and resource mapping with community members, the report documents reliance on unsafe hand-dug “Kua” pits, associated health risks (diarrhoea, skin infections, typhoid), and structural barriers (failed government infrastructure projects, deforestation, geographic isolation) — concluding with a co-developed short- and long-term action plan.

Project Justification

Demonstrates original participatory fieldwork with an Indigenous community, including trust-building with local leadership, oral informed consent in the Marma language, and direct sourcing from residents and officials. It reflects the field-reporting rigor, ethical sensitivity, and structural analysis Faria brings to marginalised-community reporting, and directly parallels the qualitative, community-centred research design used in her master's thesis methodology.

[Insert your PROJECT on the next page]

Learning and Outcomes

Learned to design and conduct participatory fieldwork with an Indigenous community, including culturally respectful entry, trust-building with local leadership, and obtaining informed consent in a language other than English or Bangla. Developed practical skills in participatory methods (Farmers Field School, transect walks, resource mapping) and in co-producing an action plan with community members rather than imposing external solutions.

Project 10: ICT for Development

Course Code and Title: MSJ3261 — ICT for Development (ICT4D), Fall 2025

Project Title: “Hasina and Friends”: A Case Study of ICT4D Project Failure in Bangladesh

Project Date: Fall 2025

Project Description

A critical case-study analysis of “Hasina and Friends,” a government-run interactive learning platform for children (ages 6–16) built under the IDEA project and shut down within two years despite an estimated BDT 18–20 crore budget. The report investigates the platform's design, procurement, and launch; identifies technical, organisational, political, and sustainability failures; and closes with actionable recommendations — user-centred design, independent monitoring, capacity building, and long-term maintenance planning — for future state-led ICT4D initiatives.

Project Justification

Demonstrates the ability to conduct an evidence-based institutional failure analysis, synthesising government records, news investigations, and academic ICT4D theory (Heeks, 2002; 2017) into a structured accountability critique. This kind of investigative, document-based analysis of public-fund mismanagement is directly aligned with the accountability journalism Faria practices professionally, and shows early command of development-communication theory applied to a real national case.

[Insert your PROJECT on the next page]

Learning and Outcomes

Learned to build an evidence-based institutional case study using government records, news investigations, and academic ICT4D theory, and to structure a failure analysis across technical, organisational, political, and sustainability dimensions. Developed skills in translating an accountability critique into concrete, actionable policy recommendations — directly relevant to investigative and accountability journalism.

Project 11: Health Comm.

Course Code and Title: MSJ3262 — Health Communication, Spring 2025

Project Title: Health Communication Plan — Diaspora Student Wellbeing Documentary

Project Date: Submitted 04 April 2025 (Spring 2025)

Project Description

A full health communication plan for a proposed documentary on food insecurity and mental health stigma among Bangladeshi university students, built on the Health Belief Model, Social Cognitive Theory, Theory of Planned Behaviour, and Agenda-Setting Theory. The plan details audience segmentation, purposive/snowball sampling of six participants, a multi-channel dissemination strategy, a budget, and ethical safeguards for discussing mental health.

Project Justification

Reflects strong grounding in applying communication theory to a stigmatised health topic — directly relevant to the ongoing master's thesis on stigma, taboo, and health information-seeking behaviour among female ULAB students, showing continuity in theoretical interest and methodological rigour.

[Insert your PROJECT on the next page]

Learning and Outcomes

Learned to apply multiple health communication theories (HBM, SCT, TPB, Agenda-Setting) together within a single plan, and to design a purposive/snowball sampling strategy for a sensitive, stigma-adjacent topic. Developed skills in ethical planning for documentary work involving vulnerable disclosures, and in budgeting and channel selection for a low-resource production.

Project 12: Emergency com.

Course Code and Title: Emergency Communication, Section 1, Fall 2025

Project Title: Dengue Outbreak Emergency Communication Plan

Project Date: Fall 2025

Project Description

A comprehensive Emergency Communication Plan addressing the preparedness, response, and early-recovery phases of a dengue outbreak in Bangladesh. The plan applies Risk Communication and Community Engagement (RCCE) principles and includes a risk/vulnerability analysis, audience segmentation (mothers, rural decision-makers, youth, frontline health workers), a colour-coded (Green/Yellow/Red) core messaging framework, a “Truth Sandwich” strategy for rumour correction, sample SMS/radio/poster content in Bangla, a multi-channel dissemination strategy, and a monitoring, feedback, and ethics framework grounded in WHO, UNICEF, and DGHS guidance.

Project Justification

This project demonstrates the ability to translate technical public-health guidance into clear, audience-specific, life-saving messaging — a core skill for health and development communication. It shows command of RCCE theory, message framing for low-literacy and high-risk audiences, and rumour-management strategy, directly building the theoretical and practical foundation (framing, source credibility, audience trust) that now underpins the master's thesis on stigma, trust, and health information-seeking behaviour.

[Insert your PROJECT on the next page]

Learning and Outcomes

Learned to apply RCCE principles to design a full-cycle emergency communication plan, including audience-specific message framing, a colour-coded triage messaging system, and a structured rumour-correction technique (“Truth Sandwich”). Developed skills in writing life-saving content in Bangla for low-literacy audiences and in coordinating multi-channel dissemination across SMS, radio, and community volunteers.

Project 13: Edutainment

Course Code and Title: Communication for Development — Edutainment Program Design

Project Title: Rongin Bangladesh — Edutainment TV Program Concept

Project Date:

Project Description

A full concept design for “Rongin Bangladesh” (“Colorful Bangladesh”), a proposed TV edutainment program addressing the marginalisation and cultural erasure of Bangladesh's ethnic minority communities (Garo, Chakma, Marma, Mro, Hajong, Santal). The proposal details a four-segment episode structure (storytelling, lifestyle, community voices, interactive quiz), a full sample episode on the Garo community, target audiences, guest structure, and the entertainment-education balance intended to build national cultural inclusion.

Project Justification

Shows the ability to design an original mass-media format that operationalises development-communication goals — cultural preservation, stereotype reduction, national harmony — into a concrete, producible program structure. This demonstrates format and audience-design thinking that complements Faria's print feature work with a broadcast/edutainment lens.

[Insert your **PROJECT** on the next page]

Learning and Outcomes

Learned to design a full broadcast format from a development-communication goal, including episode structure, audience segmentation, and a worked sample episode. Developed skills in balancing entertainment value (dramatisation, music, interactive quizzes) with educational intent, and in designing content meant to reduce stereotyping and build national cultural inclusion.

Project 14: Advertising

Course Code and Title: Advertising

Project Title: Initial Script — MACES Study Abroad Campaign

Project Date:

Project Description

A five-scene narrative advertisement script following three young women through scenes of price inflation, disengagement from political trends, and general disillusionment with the state of the country, before converging on a “study abroad” resolution promoted by an educational consultancy (MACES). Each scene is paired with an explicit social message — economic stagnation, political apathy, and loss of national faith among Bangladeshi youth.

Project Justification

Demonstrates the ability to translate socio-political commentary into a commercially viable, emotionally engaging visual narrative — showing range beyond journalistic writing into scripted commercial storytelling, while still grounding the work in genuine social observation about youth disillusionment and emigration aspiration in Bangladesh.

[Insert your **PROJECT** on the next page]

Learning and Outcomes

Learned to write a scene-by-scene commercial script that layers social commentary underneath an entertaining, character-driven narrative, and to plan visual/comedic beats (dramatic transitions, physical comedy) that keep a brand message engaging rather than didactic. Developed skills in balancing client messaging goals with authentic social observation.